

# Rules v1.0

A semi-cooperative bluffing card game for 4 players · print and play

Four players play 5 rounds of cards against hidden targets. The game ends one of three ways: one player wins alone, the player closest to zero wins when the group fails, or everyone wins together.

## What to print

| Section                 | Pages         | Notes                                                                           |
|-------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Rules and player aids   | this section  | Print once. Cut the 4 player aids apart.                                        |
| Track board             | 1 (landscape) | 4 Drift Tracks and the Group Tally. Shaded zones: solo win at 20+, bust at 23+. |
| Hand cards              | 7             | 60 cards: 1 to 15, 4 of each.                                                   |
| Personal Target cards   | 3             | 22 cards: 10 to 20, 2 of each.                                                  |
| Collective Target cards | 2             | 13 cards: 54 to 66, one of each.                                                |
| Clue cards (optional)   | 3             | 5 per player in 4 colours, plus a first-player card.                            |
| Card backs (optional)   | 4             | One page per deck, for double-sided printing.                                   |

## Assembly

- Print at **100% / actual size**, not "fit to page". Cards are 63 × 88 mm, a standard playing-card size.
- Cut along the thin grey lines. The short marks in the margins line up with every cut.
- Card backs: either print each deck's back page on the reverse of its front pages (double-sided, flip on the long edge), or put each card in a sleeve with an old playing card behind it.
- You also need **5 small markers** (coins, cubes or paper clips): one per player for their Drift Track and one for the Group Tally.
- Clue cards are optional. Placed face up beside your pocket, they keep everyone's claim on the table until the reveal, so it is easy to see who lied.

# Rules

## Goal

Each round, every player has a private aim (their **Personal Target**) and the table shares one (the **Collective Target**). Players lay cards face down, describe their total with a clue that may be a lie, and can veto each other. When the cards are revealed, how far each player missed their own target moves them along their **Drift Track**, and how far the table missed the shared target moves the **Group Tally**.

- **Solo win:** push your own track 20 or more away from zero.
- **Bust win:** if the Group Tally goes more than 22 from zero, the group loses and the player closest to zero wins.
- **Shared win:** survive all 5 rounds without either happening, and everyone wins.

## Setup

- 1 Shuffle the Hand, Personal Target and Collective Target decks separately and place them face down. No deck is ever reshuffled.
- 2 Deal 5 hand cards to each player. Hands are hidden; the number of cards each player holds is public.
- 3 Put every Drift Track marker and the Group Tally marker on 0.
- 4 Choose a first player and give them the first-player card. It moves one seat to the left each round.

## Each round

The game lasts 5 rounds. Each round has five steps; after every round, check the end of the game.

**1. Reveal targets.** Each player draws a Personal Target face up. Draw one Collective Target face up. The **gap** is the Collective Target minus the sum of the four Personal Targets: how far the table must drift together.

**2. Play and clue.** In turn order, starting with the first player, each player places **1 to 3 cards** face down as their pocket, then gives one clue about their pocket total. Clues may be true or false.

| Clue        | Pocket total compared with your Personal Target |
|-------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Much lower  | 8 or more below                                 |
| Lower       | 3 to 7 below                                    |
| Close       | within 2 either way                             |
| Higher      | 3 to 7 above                                    |
| Much higher | 8 or more above                                 |

**3. Veto.** The **leader** is the player furthest from zero; everyone tied for furthest is a leader. A player is **eligible** if they are not a leader and are at least **7** closer to zero than the leader. All eligible players declare at once (for example, point on a count of three; a fist means pass): each vetoes one other player or passes.

**4. Reveal and resolve.** Reveal every pocket. Each player's **drift** is their pocket total minus their Personal Target, with its sign.

- **Not vetoed:** move your own marker by your drift.
- **Vetoed once or more:** your drift does not move your marker. Instead, **each** player who vetoed you moves their own marker by your full drift.
- **Vetoed 2 or more times:** in addition, your contribution to the group counts as exactly your Personal Target.
- **Final round (round 5):** all drift on tracks counts double, including drift taken by a veto.
- **Group Tally:** move it by the sum of all contributions minus the Collective Target. A contribution is the pocket total, except under a double veto.

**5. Cleanup.** Revealed pocket cards go to the discard pile, face up and sorted by value. Each player draws **1** card.

## End of the game

After each round, check these in order; the first that applies ends the game.

- 1 **Bust.** If the Group Tally is 23 or more away from zero, the group has failed. The player closest to zero wins; ties share the win. A bust overrides a solo win in the same round.
- 2 **Solo win.** If any track is 20 or more away from zero, the player furthest from zero wins; ties share the win.
- 3 **Shared win.** If round 5 ends with neither, all players win together.

## Rulings

| Situation                                  | Ruling                                                                              |
|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A track passes 20                          | It keeps counting; tracks have no cap. Note the number if it runs off the board.    |
| Several players tie for furthest from zero | All are leaders and none may veto. In round 1 everyone is at 0, so nobody can veto. |
| When eligibility is checked                | On the tracks at the start of the veto step.                                        |
| A vetoes B while B vetoes C                | A takes only B's own drift, never what B took from C.                               |
| Vetoed exactly once                        | The contribution is still the real pocket total.                                    |
| Final-round doubling                       | Tracks only. The Group Tally is never doubled.                                      |
| Group Tally at exactly 22 or -22           | Not a bust; play on.                                                                |
| Lying                                      | Any clue may be false. There is no penalty except what the others remember.         |

Rules version 1.0. Rule file: bluff\_sim/configs/candidates/C.yaml.

## Player aid · Red

### Each round

- 1 Draw targets. Gap = collective – sum of personals.
- 2 Play 1-3 cards face down, then give a clue.
- 3 Veto: if  $\geq 7$  closer to zero than the leader, veto one player or pass (all at once).
- 4 Drift = pocket – personal target.  
Vetoed: each vetoer takes your drift.  
Vetoed 2+: your contribution = your target.  
Round 5: track moves  $\times 2$ .  
Tally += contributions – collective.
- 5 Discard pockets, draw 1.

### Clues (pocket vs your target)

Close: within 2

Lower / Higher: 3-7 away

Much lower / higher: 8+ away

### Game ends, checked in this order

Bust: tally 23+ from 0 → closest to 0 wins

Solo: a track 20+ from 0 → furthest wins

End of round 5: everyone wins

Rules v1.0

## Player aid · Blue

### Each round

- 1 Draw targets. Gap = collective – sum of personals.
- 2 Play 1-3 cards face down, then give a clue.
- 3 Veto: if  $\geq 7$  closer to zero than the leader, veto one player or pass (all at once).
- 4 Drift = pocket – personal target.  
Vetoed: each vetoer takes your drift.  
Vetoed 2+: your contribution = your target.  
Round 5: track moves  $\times 2$ .  
Tally += contributions – collective.
- 5 Discard pockets, draw 1.

### Clues (pocket vs your target)

Close: within 2

Lower / Higher: 3-7 away

Much lower / higher: 8+ away

### Game ends, checked in this order

Bust: tally 23+ from 0 → closest to 0 wins

Solo: a track 20+ from 0 → furthest wins

End of round 5: everyone wins

Rules v1.0

## Player aid · Green

### Each round

- 1 Draw targets. Gap = collective – sum of personals.
- 2 Play 1-3 cards face down, then give a clue.
- 3 Veto: if  $\geq 7$  closer to zero than the leader, veto one player or pass (all at once).
- 4 Drift = pocket – personal target.  
Vetoed: each vetoer takes your drift.  
Vetoed 2+: your contribution = your target.  
Round 5: track moves  $\times 2$ .  
Tally += contributions – collective.
- 5 Discard pockets, draw 1.

### Clues (pocket vs your target)

Close: within 2

Lower / Higher: 3-7 away

Much lower / higher: 8+ away

### Game ends, checked in this order

Bust: tally 23+ from 0 → closest to 0 wins

Solo: a track 20+ from 0 → furthest wins

End of round 5: everyone wins

Rules v1.0

## Player aid · Purple

### Each round

- 1 Draw targets. Gap = collective – sum of personals.
- 2 Play 1-3 cards face down, then give a clue.
- 3 Veto: if  $\geq 7$  closer to zero than the leader, veto one player or pass (all at once).
- 4 Drift = pocket – personal target.  
Vetoed: each vetoer takes your drift.  
Vetoed 2+: your contribution = your target.  
Round 5: track moves  $\times 2$ .  
Tally += contributions – collective.
- 5 Discard pockets, draw 1.

### Clues (pocket vs your target)

Close: within 2

Lower / Higher: 3-7 away

Much lower / higher: 8+ away

### Game ends, checked in this order

Bust: tally 23+ from 0 → closest to 0 wins

Solo: a track 20+ from 0 → furthest wins

End of round 5: everyone wins

Rules v1.0

Track board

Green cells: solo win at 20 or more from zero. Orange cells: bust at 23 or more from zero. Past 25? Note the number.

|                       |   |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
|-----------------------|---|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| Red<br>Drift Track    | 0 | +1 | +2 | +3 | +4 | +5 | +6 | +7 | +8 | +9 | +10 | +11 | +12 | +13 | +14 | +15 | +16 | +17 | +18 | +19 | +20 | +21 | +22 | +23 | +24 | +25 |
|                       |   | -1 | -2 | -3 | -4 | -5 | -6 | -7 | -8 | -9 | -10 | -11 | -12 | -13 | -14 | -15 | -16 | -17 | -18 | -19 | -20 | -21 | -22 | -23 | -24 | -25 |
| Blue<br>Drift Track   | 0 | +1 | +2 | +3 | +4 | +5 | +6 | +7 | +8 | +9 | +10 | +11 | +12 | +13 | +14 | +15 | +16 | +17 | +18 | +19 | +20 | +21 | +22 | +23 | +24 | +25 |
|                       |   | -1 | -2 | -3 | -4 | -5 | -6 | -7 | -8 | -9 | -10 | -11 | -12 | -13 | -14 | -15 | -16 | -17 | -18 | -19 | -20 | -21 | -22 | -23 | -24 | -25 |
| Green<br>Drift Track  | 0 | +1 | +2 | +3 | +4 | +5 | +6 | +7 | +8 | +9 | +10 | +11 | +12 | +13 | +14 | +15 | +16 | +17 | +18 | +19 | +20 | +21 | +22 | +23 | +24 | +25 |
|                       |   | -1 | -2 | -3 | -4 | -5 | -6 | -7 | -8 | -9 | -10 | -11 | -12 | -13 | -14 | -15 | -16 | -17 | -18 | -19 | -20 | -21 | -22 | -23 | -24 | -25 |
| Purple<br>Drift Track | 0 | +1 | +2 | +3 | +4 | +5 | +6 | +7 | +8 | +9 | +10 | +11 | +12 | +13 | +14 | +15 | +16 | +17 | +18 | +19 | +20 | +21 | +22 | +23 | +24 | +25 |
|                       |   | -1 | -2 | -3 | -4 | -5 | -6 | -7 | -8 | -9 | -10 | -11 | -12 | -13 | -14 | -15 | -16 | -17 | -18 | -19 | -20 | -21 | -22 | -23 | -24 | -25 |
| Group Tally<br>shared | 0 | +1 | +2 | +3 | +4 | +5 | +6 | +7 | +8 | +9 | +10 | +11 | +12 | +13 | +14 | +15 | +16 | +17 | +18 | +19 | +20 | +21 | +22 | +23 | +24 | +25 |
|                       |   | -1 | -2 | -3 | -4 | -5 | -6 | -7 | -8 | -9 | -10 | -11 | -12 | -13 | -14 | -15 | -16 | -17 | -18 | -19 | -20 | -21 | -22 | -23 | -24 | -25 |

HAND

1

1

1

HAND

1

1

1

HAND

1

1

1

HAND

1

1

1

HAND

2

2

2

HAND

2

2

2

HAND

2

2

2

HAND

2

2

2

HAND

3

3

3

HAND

3

3

€

HAND

3

3

€

HAND

3

3

€

HAND

4

4

₹

HAND

4

4

₹

HAND

4

4

₹

HAND

4

4

₹

HAND

5

5

₹

HAND

5

5

₹

HAND

5

5

5

HAND

5

5

5

HAND

6

6

9

HAND

6

6

9

HAND

6

6

9

HAND

6

6

9

HAND

7

7

7

HAND

7

7

7

HAND

7

7

7

HAND

7

7

L

HAND

8

8

8

HAND

8

8

8

HAND

8

8

8

HAND

8

8

8

HAND

9

9

6

HAND

9

9

6

HAND

9

9

6

HAND

9

9

6

HAND

10

10

01

HAND

10

10

01

HAND

10

10

01

HAND

10

10

01

HAND

11

11

11

HAND

11

11

11

HAND

11

11

11

HAND

11

11

11

HAND

12

12

12

HAND

12

12

12

HAND

12

12

12

HAND

12

12

12

HAND

13

13

13

HAND

13

13

13

HAND

13

13

13

HAND

13

13

13

HAND

14

14

14

HAND

14

14

14

HAND

14

14

14

HAND

14

14

14

HAND

15

15

15

HAND

15

15

15

HAND

15

15

15

HAND

15

15

15

PERSONAL TARGET

10

10

your aim this round

01

PERSONAL TARGET

10

10

your aim this round

01

PERSONAL TARGET

11

11

your aim this round

11

PERSONAL TARGET

11

11

your aim this round

11

PERSONAL TARGET

12

12

your aim this round

12

PERSONAL TARGET

12

12

your aim this round

12

PERSONAL TARGET

13

13

your aim this round

13

PERSONAL TARGET

13

13

your aim this round

13

PERSONAL TARGET

14

14

your aim this round

14

PERSONAL TARGET

14

14

your aim this round

14

PERSONAL TARGET

15

15

your aim this round

15

PERSONAL TARGET

15

15

your aim this round

15

PERSONAL TARGET

16

16

your aim this round

16

PERSONAL TARGET

16

16

your aim this round

16

PERSONAL TARGET

17

17

your aim this round

17

PERSONAL TARGET

17

17

your aim this round

17

PERSONAL TARGET

18

18

your aim this round

18

PERSONAL TARGET

18

18

your aim this round

18

PERSONAL TARGET

19

19

your aim this round

19

PERSONAL TARGET

19

19

your aim this round

19

PERSONAL TARGET

20

20

your aim this round

20

PERSONAL TARGET

20

20

your aim this round

20

COLLECTIVE TARGET

54

54

the table's aim

54

COLLECTIVE TARGET

55

55

the table's aim

55

COLLECTIVE TARGET

56

56

the table's aim

56

COLLECTIVE TARGET

57

57

the table's aim

57

COLLECTIVE TARGET

58

58

the table's aim

58

COLLECTIVE TARGET

59

59

the table's aim

59

COLLECTIVE TARGET

60

60

the table's aim

60

COLLECTIVE TARGET

61

61

the table's aim

61

COLLECTIVE TARGET

62

62

the table's aim

62

COLLECTIVE TARGET

63

63

the table's aim

£9

COLLECTIVE TARGET

64

64

the table's aim

79

COLLECTIVE TARGET

65

65

the table's aim

99

COLLECTIVE TARGET

66

66

the table's aim

99



**MUCH LOWER**

8 or more below target

Clue · Red



**LOWER**

3 to 7 below target

Clue · Red



**CLOSE**

within 2 of target

Clue · Red



**HIGHER**

3 to 7 above target

Clue · Red



**MUCH HIGHER**

8 or more above target

Clue · Red



**MUCH LOWER**

8 or more below target

Clue · Blue



**LOWER**

3 to 7 below target

Clue · Blue



**CLOSE**

within 2 of target

Clue · Blue



**HIGHER**

3 to 7 above target

Clue · Blue



**MUCH HIGHER**

8 or more above target

Clue · Blue



**MUCH LOWER**

8 or more below target

Clue · Green



**LOWER**

3 to 7 below target

Clue · Green



**CLOSE**

within 2 of target

Clue · Green



**HIGHER**

3 to 7 above target

Clue · Green



**MUCH HIGHER**

8 or more above target

Clue · Green



**MUCH LOWER**

8 or more below target

Clue · Purple



**LOWER**

3 to 7 below target

Clue · Purple



**CLOSE**

within 2 of target

Clue · Purple



## HIGHER

3 to 7 above target

Clue · Purple



## MUCH HIGHER

8 or more above target

Clue · Purple

## FIRST PLAYER

Passes one seat left each round

**HAND**

**HAND**

**HAND**

**HAND**

**HAND**

**HAND**

**HAND**

**HAND**

**HAND**

**PERSONAL  
TARGET**

**PERSONAL  
TARGET**

**PERSONAL  
TARGET**

**PERSONAL  
TARGET**

**PERSONAL  
TARGET**

**PERSONAL  
TARGET**

**PERSONAL  
TARGET**

**PERSONAL  
TARGET**

**PERSONAL  
TARGET**

**COLLECTIVE  
TARGET**

**COLLECTIVE  
TARGET**

**COLLECTIVE  
TARGET**

**COLLECTIVE  
TARGET**

**COLLECTIVE  
TARGET**

**COLLECTIVE  
TARGET**

**COLLECTIVE  
TARGET**

**COLLECTIVE  
TARGET**

**COLLECTIVE  
TARGET**

**CLUE**

**CLUE**

**CLUE**

**CLUE**

**CLUE**

**CLUE**

**CLUE**

**CLUE**

**CLUE**